

MIZORAM PUBLIC SERVICE COMMISSION
COMBINED COMPETITIVE EXAMINATION FOR RECRUITMENT TO THE
POST OF JUNIOR ENGINEER (J.E.) UNDER LAD, PWD AND I&WRD,
GOVERNMENT OF MIZORAM.
(APRIL, 2025)

PAPER-I (GENERAL ENGLISH)

Time Allowed : 3 hours

FM : 100

SECTION - A (Conventional Type) (40 Marks)

*This Section should be answered only on the Answer Sheet provided.
Marks for each question is indicated against it.*

1. Write a precis of the passage given below: (10)

Culture is a forbidding word. I have to use it, knowing of none better to describe the various beautiful and interesting objects which man has made in the past and handed down to us, and which some of us are hoping to hand on. Many people despise them. They argue with force that cultural stuff takes up a great deal of room and time, and better be scrapped.

Cultivated people are like drops in an ocean. They mix easily and genially with other drops, for those exclusive days are over when cultivated people made only cultivated friends, and became tongue-tied or terror-struck in the presence of anyone whose make-up was different from their own. Culture, thank goodness, is no longer a social asset, it can no longer be employed either as a barrier against the mob or as a ladder into the aristocracy.

All the same, we are a drop in the ocean. Few people share our enjoyment so far. Strictly between ourselves, and keeping our limited circulation in mind, let us put our heads together and consider for a moment our special problem, our special blessings, our special woes. No one needs to listen to us who does not want to. We whisper in the corner of a world which is full of others' noises, and louder ones.

Come closer, our problem, as I see it, is what we have got worth passing on. What we have is (roughly speaking) a little knowledge about books, pictures, tunes, and a little skill in their interpretation. Seated beside our gas fires, and beneath our electric bulbs, we inherit a tradition that has lasted for about three thousand years.

2. Write a letter to the editor of Aizawl Daily newspaper expressing your concern about the increasing thefts in Aizawl city. Sign yourself as Jonathan Varte, resident of H/no- AB101, Zarkawt, Aizawl, Mizoram. (15)
3. Read the given passage carefully and answer the questions that follow.

A majority taken collectively may be regarded as a being whose opinions and, most frequently, whose interests are opposed to those of another being, which is styled a minority. If it is admitted that a man possessing absolute power may misuse that power by wronging his adversaries, why should a majority not be liable to the same reproach? Men are not apt to change their characters by agglomeration; nor does their patience in the presence of obstacles increase with the consciousness of their strength. For these reasons we should not willingly invest any group of our fellows with that unlimited authority which we should refuse to any individual.

One social power must always predominate over others, but liberty is endangered when this power is checked by no obstacles which may retard its course and force it to moderate its own vehemence. Unlimited power is in itself a bad and dangerous thing, and no power on earth is so worthy of honor for itself or of reverential obedience to the rights which it represents that we should admit its uncontrolled and all-predominant authority. When the right and means of absolute command are conferred on a people or a king, on an aristocracy or a democracy, a monarchy or a republic, there has been implanted the germ of tyranny.

The main evil of the present democratic institutions of the United States does not arise, as is often asserted in Europe, from their weakness, but from their overpowering strength; the excessive liberty which reigns in that country is not so alarming as is the very inadequate security which exists against tyranny.

When an individual or a party is wronged in the United States, to whom can he apply for redress? If to the public opinion, public opinion constitutes the majority; if to the legislature, it represents the majority and implicitly obeys its injunctions; if to the executive power, it is appointed by the majority and remains a passive tool in its hands; the public troops consist of the majority under arms; the jury is the majority invested with the right of hearing judicial cases, and in certain states even the judges are elected by the majority. However iniquitous or absurd the evil complained about, no sure barrier is established to defend against it.

Direction (Question Nos. (a) - (f)): Find words in the passage which have the same meaning as:

(6×1=6)

(a) autocracy

- (i) freedom
- (iii) liberty

- (ii) tyranny
- (iv) anarchy

(b) opponents

- (i) leaders
- (iii) adversaries

- (ii) partners
- (iv) allies

(c) blame

- (i) reproach
- (iii) reward

- (ii) praise
- (iv) ignore

(d) collection

- (i) dispersion
- (iii) separation

- (ii) agglomeration
- (iv) scattering

(e) nobility

- (i) aristocracy
- (iii) oligarchy

- (ii) democracy
- (iv) monarchy

(f) wicked

- (i) virtuous
- (iii) iniquitous

- (ii) justified
- (iv) benign

(g) What is the main theme of the passage?

(3)

(h) What is the author's main concern regarding unlimited power?

(3)

(i) What is the author's argument about individual liberty?

(3)

SECTION - B (Multiple Choice questions) (60 Marks)

All questions carry equal mark of 1 each. Attempt all questions.

*This Section should be answered only on the **OMR Response Sheet** provided.*

Direction (Question Nos. 1-10): Identify the part of speech of the underlined words in the following sentences :-

1. The books on the shelf are theirs.
(a) noun (b) adverb
(c) pronoun (d) verb
2. The dog sat on the mat.
(a) preposition (b) adjective
(c) conjunction (d) verb
3. I like coffee but my sister likes tea.
(a) interjection (b) conjunction
(c) preposition (d) adjective
4. Wow, thats an amazing view!!
(a) conjunction (b) preposition
(c) adverb (d) interjection
5. The new project will focus on sustainable development.
(a) pronoun (b) verb
(c) noun (d) adverb
6. The company invested heavily in renewable energy.
(a) adjective (b) noun
(c) pronoun (d) adverb
7. Her tone implies she is upset.
(a) adverb (b) verb
(c) adjective (d) pronoun
8. I was pleasantly surprised to see you.
(a) verb (b) adverb
(c) adjective (d) preposition
9. Lets eat before we go out.
(a) conjunction (b) adjective
(c) preposition (d) interjection
10. Perhaps we'll see each other today.
(a) verb (b) adjective
(c) pronoun (d) adverb

Direction (Question Nos. 11-15): Choose the correct answer for each blank in the sentence:-

11. Mary _____ rather not drive at night.
(a) must (b) has to
(c) could (d) would
12. Did you have any problem _____ for the key?
(a) for searching (b) in searching
(c) searching (d) to search
13. The company will upgrade _____ computer system tomorrow.
(a) them (b) there
(c) its (d) entirely
14. I was _____ that the weather would be sunny today.
(a) hopeless (b) hopeful
(c) hope (d) hoped
15. The children _____ how to play chess.
(a) knowingly (b) knowing
(c) know (d) known

Direction (Question Nos.16-20): Select an appropriate verb, preposition and adverb to fill in the blanks:-

16. Mawia caught Rama _____ the neck.
(a) for (b) from
(c) by (d) in
17. Rita works _____.
(a) hardly (b) hard
(c) herd (d) heard
18. John spoke _____ at the talk show.
(a) confident (b) confidence
(c) confidant (d) confidently
19. Mary is _____ known for her kindness.
(a) well (b) better
(c) good (d) worse
20. I _____ my room every Saturday.
(a) was cleaning (b) clean
(c) cleaned (d) am cleaning

Direction (Question Nos. 21-25): Choose the correct synonyms from the given words :-

21. courteous
(a) abrupt (b) polite
(c) rude (d) vigilant

44. (a) Never keep away from school.
(b) The news of his death is true.
(c) This shirt of yours is very colourful.
(d) All men should love each other.
45. (a) The horse and carriage are arriving.
(b) He doesn't like to be fined.
(c) He is a man of few words.
(d) Only a few girls are as pretty as Rita.

Direction (Questions Nos. 46-50): Choose the correct word from the given options to make meaningful sentence:-

46. I have no _____ to the library.
(a) access (b) excess
(c) accessive (d) excessive
47. They were impressed by his _____ dress.
(a) descent (b) decent
(c) desent (d) decant
48. _____ up your arms.
(a) rise (b) risen
(c) raise (d) raze
49. You must act upon his _____.
(a) counsil (b) council
(c) councel (d) counsel
50. The new law will take _____ on April 2nd.
(a) affect (b) affective
(c) effect (d) effective

Direction (Question Nos. 51-55): Pick the correct word given in the options to complete each sentence:-

51. Never in my life _____ such a beauty.
(a) did I see (b) have i seen
(c) I saw (d) I have seen
52. _____ black cats bring bad luck is just superstition.
(a) The (b) It is
(c) That (d) Although
53. It is necessary _____ the books to the library immediately.
(a) to him to return (b) that he is returning
(c) that he return (d) his returning
54. The fact that reading books is becoming a rarity _____ many people.
(a) are disturbing (b) is disturbing
(c) to disturb (d) are disturbing

55. The man _____ we are looking for is sitting in the park.
(a) who (b) which
(c) whose (d) whom

Direction (Question Nos. 56-60): Choose the correct sentence:-

56. (a) The narrative was hilarious that we cannot help laughing.
(b) The narrative was hilarious that we could not help laughing.
(c) The narrative was hilarious that we cannot help laugh.
(d) The narrative was hilarious that we could not help laughed.
57. (a) She saw the painting yesterday and she liked it.
(b) She see the painting yesterday and she liked it.
(c) She sees the painting yesterday and she like it.
(d) She saw the painting yesterday and she like it.
58. (a) He is going to market.
(b) He have gone to the market.
(c) He has gone to market.
(d) He is going to the market.
59. (a) He has let himself be gone after his divorce.
(b) He has let himself going after his divorce.
(c) He has let himself go after his divorce.
(d) He has let himself gone after his divorce.
60. (a) The cattle is grazing.
(b) The cattle are grazing.
(c) The cattles are grazing.
(d) Cattle is grazing.

* * * * *

22. elaborate

- (a) explanation
- (c) omission

- (b) simplification
- (d) exaggeration

23. loquacious

- (a) exact
- (c) quiet

- (b) talkative
- (d) concise

24. avert

- (a) face
- (c) confront

- (b) permit
- (d) prevent

25. volatile

- (a) stable
- (c) unstable

- (b) constant
- (d) steady

Direction (Question Nos. 26-30): Select the most appropriate antonyms from the given options:-

26. implicit

- (a) inherent
- (c) absolute

- (b) specific
- (d) implied

27. modest

- (a) unhappy
- (c) glum

- (b) sullen
- (d) conceited

28. hospitality

- (a) wrathful
- (c) coldness

- (b) illness
- (d) cordiality

29. tenacious

- (a) persistent
- (c) yielding

- (b) relentless
- (d) steadfast

30. servile

- (a) cunning
- (c) sheepish

- (b) bickering
- (d) assertive

Direction (Question Nos. 31-35): Select appropriate word from the options that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words:-

31. to walk aimlessly

- (a) sprint
- (c) slither

- (b) crawl
- (d) amble

32. to stare at someone or something

- (a) ogle
- (c) overlook

- (b) ignore
- (d) admire

33. to move or walk idly

- (a) drag
- (c) expedite

- (b) dawdle
- (d) hinder

34. having two feet
(a) bi-footed (b) bipolar
(c) biped (d) pedestrian
35. left side of page in a book
(a) recto (b) verso
(c) spread (d) margin

Direction (Questions Nos. 36-40): Choose the meaning of the prepositional phrase from the given options:-

36. at home in
(a) to be at home (b) good at
(c) indoor (d) homely
37. for want of
(a) wanting (b) not needed
(c) lack of (d) wanted
38. in spite of
(a) instead (b) however
(c) despite (d) moreover
39. in the guise of
(a) disguised as (b) disappointed
(c) guilty of (d) disappear from
40. at the top of
(a) high places (b) upper limit
(c) cover up (d) roof

Direction (Questions Nos. 41-45): Pick out one of the sentences that is grammatically or contextually incorrect:-

41. (a) Either my sister or my brother is coming.
(b) Two gallons of water is too many to drink in a day.
(c) Today we have an appointment at the doctor's clinic.
(d) Many a person believes that hard work leads to success.
42. (a) The team, along with the coach was celebrating the victory.
(b) Neither the boys nor the girls could come.
(c) There are less people at the funeral than expectation.
(d) She runs faster than her brother.
43. (a) Anna is speaking more loudly than her brother.
(b) Fruit was served after dinner.
(c) There is no room for you on this table.
(d) Either of the two girls is singing.